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Inventor(s)	Tsou; Wen-Chieh et al.

Complex sensing device packaging structure and packaging method

Abstract

A complex sensing device packaging structure and packaging method are disclosed. The packaging structure includes a substrate disposed with a light emitting element and a light sensing chip. A first non-transparent material is disposed on the light sensing chip. A transparent molding material surrounds the light emitting element, the light sensing chip and the first non-transparent material. A second non-transparent material is disposed inside the transparent molding material, and the second non-transparent material is connected with the first non-transparent material.

Inventors:	Tsou; Wen-Chieh (Jhubei, TW), Chang; Yi-Hua (Jhubei, TW)
Applicant:	SENSORTEK TECHNOLOGY CORP. (Jhubei, TW)
Family ID:	1000008780320
Assignee:	Sensortek Technology Corp. (Jhubei, TW)
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Primary Examiner: Salerno; Sarah K
Attorney, Agent or Firm: Rosenberg, Klein & Lee

Background/Summary

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

(1) The present invention relates to a complex sensing device packaging structure and packaging method, in particular to the light complex sensing device packaging structure with a shielding element and the packaging method thereof.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(2) Proximity sensors and ambient light sensors are widely used in portable communication devices such as mobile phones and consumer electronics. The proximity sensor and the ambient light sensor both require a light sensing element, and the proximity sensor further requires a light emitting element (e.g., an infrared transmitter or a laser emitter).

(3) In order to avoid lights generated by the light emitting element from interfering with the light sensing element, a conventional method is to provide a shielding element between the light sensing element and the light emitting element to avoid crosstalk. A conventional packaging process is to use a metal cover or a plastic cover as the shielding element. However, the metal cover or the plastic cover are formed by a customized mold. Due to the limitation of mold manufacturing,

difficulty in making the mold of the shielding element significantly increases when the shielding element miniaturizes as sizes of a circuit area and the sensors shrink. In addition, the miniaturized metal cover or miniaturized plastic cover is hard to be fixed and easily misplaced.

(4) As shown in FIG. 1, another conventional packaging process is to cut a transparent molding material **91** that seals the light emitting element **92** and the light sensing chip **93**, and then fill the cut-out groove with black resin to form a shielding element **94** to prevent the light sensing elements on the light sensing chip **93** from directly receiving the light emitted from the light emitting element **92**. However, the cutting process will cause damage to the structure, so no wires or circuitry can be placed near the area where the grooves are scheduled to be cut. Thus, this approach will occupy the space for wire bonding of the light sensing chip **93**, which is not conducive to miniaturized package design.

(5) Based on the abovementioned disadvantages, it is necessary to provide a packaging structure and process for the proximity sensor and the ambient light sensor to avoid crosstalk, miniaturize size, and meet the practical requirements.

SUMMARY

(6) It is therefore an objective of the present invention to provide a complex sensing device packaging structure and packaging method, and particularly to the complex sensing device packaging structure made by placing a first opaque material on the light sensing chip, forming a shaping space on the transparent molding material which is connected to the first opaque material, and then filling a second opaque material into the shaping space to connect the first opaque material to form a shielding element.

(7) The present invention disclosed a complex sensing device packaging structure comprises a substrate disposed with a light emitting element and a light sensing chip; a first opaque material set on the light sensing chip; a transparent molding material enclosed the light emitting element, the light sensing chip and the first opaque material; and a second opaque material set within the transparent molding material and connected to the first opaque material.

(8) The present invention further disclosed a complex sensing device packaging method comprises disposing a light emitting element and a light sensing chip on a substrate; setting a first opaque material on the light sensing chip; sealing the light emitting element and the light sensing chip in a transparent molding material; forming a shaping space on the transparent molding material which is connected to the first opaque material; and filling the shaping space with a second opaque material connected to the first opaque material, so that the first opaque material and the second opaque material together form a shielding element.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 illustrates a conventional packaging structure of a sensing device.
- (2) FIG. 2 to FIG. 7 illustrate a packaging process of a complex sensing device packaging structure according to an embodiment of the present invention.
- (3) FIG. 8 is a flowchart of a packaging process according to an embodiment of the present invention.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(4) FIG. 2 to FIG. 7 illustrate a packaging process of a complex sensing device packaging structure according to an embodiment of the present invention. The complex sensing device packaging structure includes a substrate **10**, a light emitting element **11**, and a light sensing chip **12**. The light sensing chip **12** is generally an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), which is manufactured by an integrated circuit process and may contain light sensing elements and operational circuits (e.g., light sensing elements and operational circuits for a proximity sensor

and/or an ambient light sensor).

(5) As shown in FIG. 2, the light emitting element **11** and the light sensing chip **12** are disposed on the substrate **10**, wherein the light emitting element **11** and the light sensing chip **12** may be connected to the substrate **10** by wire bonding. However, in addition to a wire bonding process, the light emitting element **11** and the light sensing chip **12** can be connected to the substrate **10** by other methods, which is not limited in the present invention. In an embodiment, the substrate **10** is a copper substrate, a ceramic substrate, a lead frame, a resin substrate or a printed circuit board, and the wires of the wire bonding process can be gold wires, which is not limited.

(6) In this embodiment, the complex sensing device packaging structure can be integrated with a proximity sensor (PS) and an ambient light sensor (ALS). The light emitting element **11** is configured to generate a transmission light (e.g., an infrared light). The light sensing chip **12** is configured to receive a reflected light of the transmission light, which allows the proximity sensor to calculate distance according to the transmission light and the reflected light. In addition, the light sensing chip **12** is also configured to receive an ambient light generated by ambient light sources, which allows the ambient light sensor to calculate light intensity. In an embodiment, computation circuits and light sensing elements for the proximity sensor and the ambient light sensor are disposed in a same area of the light sensing chip **12**. In another embodiment, components of the proximity sensor and components of the ambient light sensor are disposed in different areas of the light sensing chip **12**, which is not limited in the present invention.

(7) Under a limited space, in order to reduce a crosstalk between the light sensing chip **12** and the light emitting element **11**, the present invention forms an opaque shielding element between the light sensing chip **12** and the light emitting element **11** to avoid light sensing chip **12** from directly receiving the transmission light generated by the light emitting element **11**.

(8) The complex sensing device packaging structure of this embodiment is first set up with a first opaque material on the light sensing chip **12**. Specifically, as shown in FIG. 2, liquid opaque adhesive **20** can be dripped (including by dispensing, smearing, etc.) onto the light sensing chip **12** in this embodiment. The liquid opaque adhesive **20** may be liquid at room temperature, so it can be applied to the light sensing chip **12** without heating or pressuring. The liquid opaque adhesive **20** can cover the surface of the photographic chip **12**.

(9) As shown in FIG. 3, a solidification process is performed to the complex sensing device packaging structure to solidify the liquid opaque adhesive **20**, so as to form the first opaque material **21**. The solidification process is a process to convert the liquid opaque adhesive **20** into a solid material. For example, the solidification process can be baking when the liquid opaque adhesive **20** is epoxy resin, i.e., heating the complex sensing device packaging structure to solidify. However, based on the material of the liquid opaque adhesive **20**, the solidification process can be a room/low temperature solidification process (in which the liquid opaque adhesive **20** is contacted with gas or liquid to solidify), an ultraviolet solidification process, and the like.

(10) As shown in FIG. 4, the light emitting element **11** and the light sensing chip **12** are sealed in the transparent molding material **3**. For example, by injecting a liquid transparent substance (e.g., resin) into a mold, forming a transparent molding material **3** after solidification the liquid transparent substance, and removing the mold to encapsulate the light emitting element **11** and the light sensing chip **12** in the transparent molding material **3**.

(11) As shown in FIG. 4, a shaping space **31** is formed on the transparent molding materials **3**. The shaping space **31** is connected to the first opaque material **21**. For example, in this embodiment, a cutting knife or abrasive knife can be used to cut a groove on the transparent molded material **3** to form a groove-shaped shaping space **31**. The cutting process only needs to cut down to the position of the first opaque material **21**, so that the shaping space **31** can be connected to the first opaque material **21**, such that the first opaque material **21** is exposed in the shaping space **31**. The cutting process can also partially remove a portion of the first opaque material **21** to increase the surface area of the first opaque material **21** exposed in the shaping space **31**, but the present invention is

not limited to this.

(12) In FIG. 5, the shaping space **31** has a shape of I-shape. However in this embodiment, since the operation circuits and light sensing elements of the proximity sensor and/or the ambient light sensor can be disposed in the same area, the light sensing elements can be set far from the light emitting element **11** and the operation circuits can be set close to the light emitting element **11** during the circuit layout design, the area of the shaping space **31** can extend above the operation circuits so that the shaping space **31** has an reverse L-shape without affecting the light-sensing capability of the light sensing elements. Alternatively, in other embodiments of the present invention, the shaping space **31** may have T-shaped, funnel-shaped, or other shapes.

(13) Fill the shaping space **31** with a second opaque material **22**, so that the first opaque material **21** and the second opaque material **22** together form a shielding element. Specifically, as shown in FIG. 6, liquid opaque adhesive **20** can be dripped (including by dispensing, smearing, etc.) into the shaping space **31** in this embodiment. Then as shown in FIG. 7 a solidification process is performed to the complex sensing device packaging structure to solidify the liquid opaque adhesive **20**, so as to form the second opaque material **22**. As such, the first opaque material **21** and the second opaque material **22** can together form the shielding element.

(14) In this embodiment, the present invention chooses the liquid opaque adhesive **20** made of epoxy resin, silicone glue, resin and silicone complex glue, or acrylic adhesive. The opaque material **20** can be an inherently opaque substance such as a black epoxy resin. The opaque material **20** can also be made opaque by doping with fillers such as dye, carbon black, silica or titanium dioxide. In this way, the first opaque material **21** and the second opaque material **22** formed after solidification of the liquid opaque adhesive **20** has light blocking effect.

(15) The complex sensing device packaging structure according to the embodiment of the present invention provide the opaque shielding element between the light emitting element **11** and the light sensing chip **12** to avoid light sensing chip **12** from directly receiving the transmission light generated by the light emitting element **11**. In such a structure, the transmission light generated by the light emitting element **11** may propagate through the transparent molding material **3**, the ambient light and the reflected light may propagate through the transparent molding material **3** to be received by a light sensing area "A" of the light sensing chop **12**, and the shielding element between the light emitting element **11** and the light sensing chip **12** may avoid the transmission light generated by the light emitting element **11** from directly receiving by the light sensing chip **12**, which satisfies the need of light transmission/reception and reduces crosstalk.

(16) It is noteworthy that, in the conventional packaging process, which is to directly cut the transparent molding material **91**, and then fill the cut-out groove with black resin to form the shielding element **94**, it will occupy the space of the light sensing chip **93** which should be used for wire bonding. In comparison, in the complex sensing device packaging structure according to the embodiment of the present invention, a first opaque material **21** is first set onto the light sensing chop **12**, and the light emitting element **11**, the light sensing chip **12** and the first opaque material **21** are sealed in a transparent molding material **3**, then the formation of a second opaque material **21** on the transparent molding material **3** to connect the first opaque material **21** is made.

Accordingly, the process of cutting the transparent molded material **3** to form the shaping space **31** for the second opaque material **21** only needs to cut down to the position of the first opaque material **21**, and does not cause any damage to the light sensing chip **12** and the light emitting element **11**. Therefore, there is no need to reserve space on the substrate **10** for the cutting process, and it will not occupy the circuit setup space of the light sensing chip **12**, nor will it occupy the space for the wire bonding of the light sensing chip **12** and the light emitting element **11**, meeting the requirement of miniaturized packaging.

(17) Further in details, please refer to FIG. 7. The complex sensing device packaging structure according to the embodiment of the present invention is to form the first opaque material **21** by applying liquid opaque adhesive **20** to the surface of the light sensing chip **12** and covering it on

the surface of the light sensing chip **12**. This method does not cause structural damage, and its process has less difficulty. Such method only have to ensure that the first opaque material **21** is formed between the light sensing area “A” of the light sensing chip **12** and the light emitting element **11**, which has higher practicality and operational flexibility. On the other hand, a separation area “B” between the first opaque material **21** and the light emitting element **11** will not be cut in. Therefore, the substrate **10** can be set up for the circuitry or wires of the light emitting element **11** and the light sensing chip **12**, so that the distance between the light emitting element **11** and the light sensing chip **12** can be further shortened to achieve the purpose of miniaturization.

(18) The manufacturing method for the complex sensing device packaging structures can be summarized into a packaging process, as shown in FIG. **8**, the packaging process includes but not limited the following steps.

(19) Dispose a light emitting element and a light sensing chip on a substrate.

(20) Set a first opaque material on the light sensing chip.

(21) Seal the light emitting element and the light sensing chip in a transparent molding material.

(22) Form a shaping space on the transparent molding material which is connected to the first opaque material. The shaping space may be formed by cutting the transparent molding material.

(23) Fill the shaping space with a second opaque material connected to the first opaque material, so that the first opaque material and the second opaque material together form a shielding element.

(24) In sum, by placing a first opaque material on the light sensing chip, forming a shaping space on the transparent molding material which is connected to the first opaque material, and then filling a second opaque material into the shaping space to connect the first opaque material to form a shielding element, the complex sensing device packaging structure and its packaging method of the present invention can not only reduce the crosstalk between the light emitting element and the light sensing chip, but also reduce the process difficulty and shorten the distance between the light emitting element and the light sensing chip to meet the needs of miniaturized packaging.

(25) By means of the above-disclosed embodiment of the present invention, a person skilled in the art may think of simple variations of the invention. For example, as shown in FIG. **5**, instead of cutting the transparent molded material **3** to form the shaping space **31**, a mold can be covered onto the complex sensing device packaging structure and abutted against the first opaque material **21**, and a liquid transparent substance (e.g., a resin) can be injected into the mold to form the transparent molded material **3** after solidification, and the mold abutted against the first opaque material **21** can be removed. In this way, the light emitting element **11**, the light sensing chip **12** and the first opaque substance **21** can be sealed in the transparent molding material **3**, and the molding space **31** connected to the first opaque substance **21** can be formed together. This approach has the advantage of further streamlining the manufacturing process, but has the disadvantage of low process flexibility (e.g., the molds cannot be reused in different sizes of composite sensor device packaging structures). The former approach of cutting by cutting knife or abrasive knife to form the shaping spaces **31** is more flexible (e.g., cutting knife or abrasive knife can be utilized to shape diverse shapes). a person skilled in the art n can choose the shaping method for the shaping space according to the actual needs.

(26) Those skilled in the art will readily observe that numerous modifications and alterations of the device and method can be made while retaining the teachings of the invention. Accordingly, the above disclosure should be construed as limited only by the metes and bounds of the appended claims.

Claims

1. A complex sensing device packaging method, comprising: disposing a light emitting element and a light sensing chip on a substrate; setting a first opaque material on the light sensing chip; sealing the light emitting element and the light sensing chip in a transparent molding material, wherein

further includes abutting a mold against the first opaque material, injecting a liquid transparent substance into the mold to form the transparent molded material after solidification, and removing the mold abutted against the first opaque material to form a shaping space on the transparent molding material which is connected to the first opaque material; and filling the shaping space with a second opaque material connected to the first opaque material, so that the first opaque material and the second opaque material together form a shielding element.
